Chapter 91 — Battery & Network Efficiency

> **Part X — Performance, Observability & Quality** · Complexity: **Standard** (≥25 interview questions)
>
> **Prerequisites:** Ch 47 (Doze/App Standby), Ch 48 (WorkManager), Ch 46/background work, Ch 68 (network state), Ch 82 (analytics batching), Ch 85 (perf monitoring). Pairs with Ch 29 (offline/sync), Ch 50 (FCM), Ch 59 (images).
>
> **Reference surface in StreamCart:** keeping the app a **good citizen** of battery and data — minimizing **wakelocks/wakeups**, **batching** and **deferring** background work to efficient windows (WorkManager, Doze-aware, Ch 47/48), **coalescing** network requests, honoring **metered/Data Saver** and network type (Ch 68), and using **efficient sync** (delta, backoff, push-over-poll, Ch 29/50) — because battery drain and data overuse cause **uninstalls**, bad reviews, **Android vitals** "excessive background" flags, and OS throttling.

91.1 Problem Definition and Real-World Context

An app that **drains battery** or **burns mobile data** gets **uninstalled**, earns **1-star reviews**, is flagged by **Android vitals** ("excessive wakeups / background Wi-Fi scans / partial wakelocks"), and is **throttled** by the OS (Doze/App Standby/background limits, Ch 47). **Battery & network efficiency** is the discipline of being a **good citizen**: minimizing **wakeups and wakelocks**, **batching** and **deferring** background work to **efficient windows** (WorkManager with constraints, Doze-aware maintenance windows, Ch 47/48), **coalescing** and **minimizing** network requests, **respecting metered networks / Data Saver** and network type (Ch 68), and using **efficient data transfer** (delta sync, compression, backoff, **push over poll**, Ch 29/50). The core principle: **do less, less often, batched, at the right time, over the right network** — and let the **platform's deferred-execution primitives** (WorkManager, JobScheduler, Doze) schedule work efficiently instead of fighting them.

Concretely, teams hit:

- **Frequent wakeups / polling (the #1 drain).** Polling a server every minute, a short-interval alarm, or a tight background loop **wakes the device/radio** constantly — each radio wake costs energy for seconds (the **radio tail**). **Fix:** don't poll — use **push (FCM, Ch 50)**; **batch**; use **deferrable** work (WorkManager, Ch 48).
- **Wakelocks held too long.** A **partial wakelock** that isn't released (or a `WAKE_LOCK` for work that should be deferrable) keeps the CPU awake → Android vitals **"stuck partial wakelock"**. **Fix:** avoid manual wakelocks; let **WorkManager** hold them minimally; always release.
- **Fighting Doze/App Standby (Ch 47).** Work scheduled to run "now, every N minutes" is **deferred/batched** by **Doze** anyway (Ch 47) — fighting it (exact alarms, foreground services for deferrable work) drains battery and may be restricted. **Fix:** use **deferrable** APIs that run in **Doze maintenance windows**; reserve exact alarms/FGS for truly time-critical user-facing work (Ch 47/49).
- **Un-batched / chatty network.** Many small requests, each waking the radio and paying the **tail** cost; no **coalescing**. **Fix: batch** uploads (analytics, Ch 82), **coalesce** syncs, piggyback requests, prefetch in **one** window.
- **Ignoring metered / Data Saver / network type (Ch 68).** Doing large transfers on **metered** cellular or when **Data Saver** is on burns the user's **data** (and money). **Fix:** gate heavy work on **unmetered** (Wi-Fi) via

WorkManager **constraints**; honor **Data Saver** (`ConnectivityManager.restrictBackgroundStatus`); adapt quality by network type (Ch 68/59).

- **Inefficient data transfer.** Full re-downloads instead of **delta sync** (Ch 29); no **compression** (gzip); no **caching** (re-fetching unchanged data, Ch 67); aggressive retry without **backoff** (Ch 29). **Fix:** delta sync, compression, HTTP caching, exponential **backoff + jitter**.
- **Wasteful location / sensors (Ch 65).** High-accuracy continuous location or sensor polling in the background is a top drain. **Fix:** lowest-adequate accuracy, batched location, stop when not needed (Ch 65).
- **No measurement.** Not knowing where battery/data goes. **Fix: Battery Historian** / Android vitals (excessive-background metrics, Ch 85), **Network Inspector**, JankStats-style field monitoring of background behavior.

The architecture: be a **good battery/data citizen** by **minimizing wakeups/wakelocks** (push over poll, Ch 50; no tight loops/short alarms), **batching and deferring** background work to **efficient windows** via **WorkManager** with **constraints** (unmetered, charging, idle) that cooperate with **Doze/App Standby** (Ch 47/48), **coalescing and minimizing** network requests (batch uploads, delta sync, compression, HTTP caching, backoff+jitter, Ch 29/82/67), **honoring metered/Data Saver and network type** (gate heavy work on Wi-Fi, adapt quality, Ch 68/59), and **measuring** with Battery Historian / Android vitals / Network Inspector (Ch 85). This chapter is about **doing less, batched, at the right time, over the right network**.

Three practical use cases

1. **Replace polling with push (StreamCart).** The app polled for order updates every 2 min, draining battery and data. Fix: **FCM push** (Ch 50) for updates; a **deferrable WorkManager** reconcile when needed — wakeups drop drastically; Android vitals "excessive wakeups" clears.
2. **Gate media prefetch on Wi-Fi (Ch 68/59).** Prefetching video thumbnails on metered cellular burned data. Fix: WorkManager `NetworkType.UNMETERED` constraint + honor **Data Saver** → heavy transfers only on Wi-Fi; adapt quality on cellular (Ch 59).
3. **Batch analytics + delta sync (Ch 82/29).** Per-event network sends and full catalog re-downloads wasted battery/data. Fix: **batch** analytics (Ch 82), **delta sync** the catalog (Ch 29), **gzip** + HTTP caching → far fewer, smaller requests.

Why this is architectural

Battery/network efficiency composes Doze/App Standby (Ch 47), WorkManager (Ch 48), network state / metered / Data Saver (Ch 68), push (FCM, Ch 50), offline/delta sync (Ch 29), analytics batching (Ch 82), and measurement (Ch 85). The decisions — push over poll, batch + defer with constraints, respect metered/Doze, efficient transfer, measure — determine whether the app drains the device (uninstall, vitals flags, throttling) or coexists well.

91.2 Requirements Engineering

Functional requirements

ID	Requirement
F1	Minimize wakeups/wakelocks: push over poll (Ch 50); no tight loops/short alarms.
F2	Batch + defer background work to efficient windows (WorkManager + constraints, Doze-aware, Ch 47/48).
F3	Coalesce + minimize network requests (batch uploads, delta sync, compression, caching, Ch 29/82/67).
F4	Honor metered / Data Saver / network type; gate heavy work on unmetered (Ch 68).
F5	Use efficient transfer: delta, gzip, HTTP cache, backoff+jitter (Ch 29/67).
F6	Measure: Battery Historian, Android vitals excessive-background, Network Inspector (Ch 85).

Non-functional requirements

Attribute	Policy
Battery	Minimal wakeups/wakelocks; Doze-cooperative (Ch 47).
Data	Metered/Data-Saver aware; small, coalesced transfers (Ch 68).
Timeliness	Time-critical via push/exact; everything else deferrable (Ch 47/50).
Citizenship	No Android vitals excessive-background flags (Ch 85).
Measured	Battery Historian / vitals / Network Inspector (Ch 85).

Scope

- **In scope:** wakeups/wakelocks + radio tail, push-over-poll (Ch 50), deferrable/batched work (WorkManager constraints, Doze/App Standby cooperation, Ch 47/48), request coalescing + batching (Ch 82), metered/Data Saver/network-type awareness (Ch 68), efficient transfer (delta sync Ch 29, gzip, HTTP caching Ch 67, backoff+jitter), location/sensor efficiency pointer (Ch 65), measurement (Battery Historian, vitals, Network Inspector, Ch 85).
- **Out of scope:** Doze/Standby mechanics (Ch 47), WorkManager detail (Ch 48), network-state detail (Ch 68), FCM detail (Ch 50), sync detail (Ch 29), location detail (Ch 65), image adaptation (Ch 59).

Assumptions & constraints

- WorkManager for deferrable work (Ch 48) cooperating with Doze/App Standby (Ch 47); FCM for push (Ch 50); `ConnectivityManager` for metered/Data Saver/type (Ch 68). Heavy work **gated on unmetered**; transfers **delta/compressed/cached**; retries **backoff+jitter**. Measured via Battery Historian / vitals (Ch 85). `minSdk 24`.

91.3 System Design Fundamentals

- **Why wakeups and the radio tail cost so much.** Waking the CPU from idle and (especially) the **cellular radio** from low-power state costs energy; after a transfer the radio stays in a high-power state for **seconds** (the **"tail"**) before idling. So **many small, spread-out** requests are far worse than **few batched** ones — each pays the wake + tail. **Batching** requests into **one window** amortizes the tail. Frequent **wakeups** (alarms, polling) and **partial wakelocks** keep the device from sleeping — the top battery drains, and exactly what **Android vitals** flags.
- **Push over poll (Ch 50). Polling** (ask the server repeatedly "anything new?") wakes the radio on every poll, mostly to hear "no" — hugely wasteful. **Push** (**FCM**, Ch 50) delivers updates **only when there's something**, over a **shared, OS-managed** connection (no per-app radio wake). **Always prefer push** for server-driven updates; poll only as a fallback, with long intervals + backoff.
- **Defer and batch with WorkManager + constraints (Ch 48).** Most background work is **not time-critical** and should be **deferrable** — give it to **WorkManager**, which **batches** it with other work and runs it in **efficient windows** respecting **constraints**: `NetworkType. UNMETERED` (Wi-Fi), `requiresCharging`, `requiresDeviceIdle`, `requiresBatteryNotLow`. WorkManager cooperates with **Doze/App Standby** (Ch 47) — it runs your work in **maintenance windows** instead of waking the device. **Don't fight the scheduler**; express **constraints** and let it choose the time.
- **Cooperate with Doze / App Standby (Ch 47). Doze** (device idle) and **App Standby** (unused app) **defer** background work, network, and alarms to **batched maintenance windows**. Work scheduled "every N minutes" is **coalesced** by Doze anyway. **Cooperate**: use **deferrable** APIs (WorkManager), reserve **exact alarms** (`setExactAndAllowWhileIdle`) and **foreground services** for **genuinely time-critical, user-facing** work (alarms, navigation, Ch 47/49) — misusing them to bypass Doze drains battery and risks restriction.
- **Coalesce and minimize network (Ch 82). Batch** outbound (analytics events, logs, Ch 82) into periodic flushes; **coalesce** multiple syncs into one; **piggyback** small requests; **prefetch** in a single window. Fewer, larger, batched requests beat many small ones (radio tail). **Minimize** payloads (only what's needed).
- **Honor metered / Data Saver / network type (Ch 68). Metered** (cellular, or metered Wi-Fi) means the user **pays per byte**; **Data Saver** (`restrictBackgroundStatus`) means the user asked to **limit background data**. **Gate heavy transfers on unmetered (Wi-Fi)** via WorkManager constraints; **honor Data Saver** (skip/deferred background data); **adapt** (lower image/video quality on cellular, Ch 59/68). Respecting this saves the user **money**.
- **Efficient data transfer (Ch 29/67).** Transfer **less**: **delta sync** (only changes, not full re-download, Ch 29); **compression** (gzip/brotli); **HTTP caching** (ETags/Cache-Control — don't re-fetch unchanged, Ch 67); **pagination** (don't over-fetch); **backoff + jitter** on retries (don't hammer, Ch 29). Less bytes + fewer requests = less battery + data.
- **Location / sensors (Ch 65).** Continuous **high-accuracy** location or sensor polling is a **top** background drain. Use the **lowest adequate accuracy**, **batched** location updates, **geofencing** over continuous tracking where possible, and **stop** when not needed (Ch 65).
- **Foreground services are not free (Ch 49).** A foreground service keeps the app alive and can bypass background limits, but **drains battery** and (Android 14+) requires a **typed** FGS for a user-visible ongoing task. Use it only for **genuinely ongoing, user-aware** work (playback, navigation, active upload) — not to run deferrable background work (Ch 49).
- **Measurement (Ch 85). Battery Historian** (bugreport analysis — wakelocks, wakeups, radio) and **Android vitals** (**excessive wakeups, stuck partial wakelocks, excessive background Wi-Fi scans, excessive**

background network) show battery behavior in the **field**. **Network Inspector** / profiler shows request count/size/timing. **Measure** to find the drain, then fix the specific cause.

Core insight: **be a good battery and data citizen by doing less, less often, batched, at the right time, over the right network — because every CPU wakeup and (especially) every cellular radio wake pays a multi-second tail cost, so many small spread-out requests drain far more than a few batched ones: prefer push (FCM, Ch 50) over polling so the radio wakes only when there's real news; hand all non-time-critical work to WorkManager with constraints (UNMETERED, charging, idle, battery-not-low) so it batches into Doze maintenance windows instead of waking the device, and cooperate with Doze/App Standby rather than fighting them with exact alarms or foreground services (reserve those for genuinely time-critical, user-facing work, Ch 47/49); coalesce and batch network (analytics flushes Ch 82, combined syncs, piggybacked requests), minimize payloads, and transfer efficiently (delta sync Ch 29, gzip, ETag/HTTP caching Ch 67, pagination, backoff+jitter); honor metered networks and Data Saver by gating heavy transfers on Wi-Fi and adapting quality on cellular (Ch 68/59) to save the user money; use lowest-adequate-accuracy, batched location (Ch 65); and measure with Battery Historian, Android vitals excessive-background metrics, and the Network Inspector (Ch 85) — because battery drain and data overuse cause uninstalls, bad reviews, vitals flags that hurt ranking, and OS throttling.**

91.4 High-Level Architecture


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Components & ownership

- **Time-critical** → exact alarm / typed FGS (sparingly, Ch 47/49); **everything else** → deferrable **WorkManager + constraints** (Doze-aware, Ch 47/48).
- **Push (FCM)** over poll (Ch 50); **batch/coalesce** (Ch 82); **metered/Data-Saver gating** (Ch 68).
- **Efficient transfer** (delta/gzip/cache/backoff, Ch 29/67); **measured** (Battery Historian/ vitals, Ch 85).

Direction: classify (time-critical vs deferrable) → push over poll + WorkManager constraints → batch/coalesce → metered-aware → efficient transfer → good citizen; measured.

91.5 Detailed Component Design


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Component	Responsibility
`WorkScheduler`	deferrable WorkManager work + constraints (Doze-aware, Ch 47/48)
`PushVsPoll`	FCM push over poll; long-interval backoff fallback (Ch 50)
`RequestCoalescer`	batch uploads + coalesce syncs + minimize payload (Ch 82)
`NetworkPolicy`	metered/Data-Saver/type gating + quality adaptation (Ch 68/59)
`EfficientTransfer`	delta sync + gzip + HTTP cache + backoff+jitter (Ch 29/67)

91.6 End-to-End Data Flow

Classify → schedule efficiently → transfer



Radio tail: batched vs chatty



91.7 Complete Kotlin Implementation

Package: `com.streamcart.efficiency`.

91.7.1 Deferrable work with constraints (Doze-aware, Ch 48/47)

```
// Non-time-critical sync: let WorkManager batch it into efficient windows (Ch 48), honoring
Doze (Ch 47)
val syncWork = PeriodicWorkRequestBuilder<CatalogSyncWorker>(6, TimeUnit.HOURS)
    .setConstraints(Constraints.Builder()
        .setRequiredNetworkType(NetworkType.UNMETERED)       // Wi-Fi only - save data (Ch 68)
        .setRequiresBatteryNotLow(true)                       // don't drain a low battery
        .setRequiresCharging(false)                           // charging optional
        .build())
    .setBackoffCriteria(BackoffPolicy.EXPONENTIAL, 15, TimeUnit.MINUTES)  // backoff on failure
(Ch 29)
    .build()
workManager.enqueueUniquePeriodicWork("catalog-sync", ExistingPeriodicWorkPolicy.KEEP, syncWork)
// NEVER: a 1-minute repeating alarm or a tight polling loop - that's what drains battery +
trips vitals.
```

91.7.2 Push over poll (Ch 50)

```
// GOOD: server pushes order updates via FCM - radio wakes only when there IS an update (Ch 50)
class StreamCartMessagingService : FirebaseMessagingService() {
    override fun onMessageReceived(msg: RemoteMessage) {
        // handle update; optionally enqueue a deferrable reconcile (Ch 48) - no polling needed
        orderRepository.onPushUpdate(msg.data)
    }
}
// BAD: viewModelScope.launch { while (true) { delay(120_000); api.pollOrders() } }  // wakes
radio constantly
```

91.7.3 Metered / Data Saver awareness (Ch 68)

```
@Singleton
class NetworkPolicy @Inject constructor(private val cm: ConnectivityManager) {   // Ch 68
    fun isUnmetered(): Boolean {
        val caps = cm.getNetworkCapabilities(cm.activeNetwork) ?: return false
        return caps.hasCapability(NetworkCapabilities.NET_CAPABILITY_NOT_METERED)   // Wi-
Fi/unmetered
    }
    fun isDataSaverOn(): Boolean =                                                  // user
asked to limit bg data
        cm.restrictBackgroundStatus == ConnectivityManager.RESTRICT_BACKGROUND_STATUS_ENABLED
    /** Gate heavy transfers; adapt quality on cellular (Ch 59). */
    fun allowHeavyTransfer(): Boolean = isUnmetered() && !isDataSaverOn()
}
// Image/video quality adapts by network type (Ch 59/68): lower res on cellular, full on Wi-Fi.
```

91.7.4 Efficient transfer: delta + gzip + cache + backoff (Ch 29/67)

```
val client = OkHttpClient.Builder()
    .addInterceptor { chain ->                                  // request gzip (servers often
honor)
        chain.proceed(chain.request().newBuilder().header("Accept-Encoding", "gzip").build())
    }
    .cache(Cache(cacheDir, 20L * 1024 * 1024))                  // HTTP cache - don't re-fetch
unchanged (Ch 67)
    .build()
// Delta sync: send last-sync cursor; server returns ONLY changes (Ch 29), not the full catalog.
suspend fun syncCatalog(sinceCursor: String): Delta =
    api.catalogDelta(sinceCursor)                               // minimal bytes; ETag/If-None-
Match -> 304 (Ch 67)
// Retries use exponential backoff + JITTER (Ch 29) - never a tight retry loop.
```

91.7.5 Batch outbound (coalesce, Ch 82)

```
// Analytics/logs are BATCHED, not sent per-event (Ch 82) - coalesces radio wakes into periodic
flushes.
class BatchingUploader @Inject constructor(private val wm: WorkManager) {
    fun enqueue(event: Event) {
        buffer.add(event)                                       // durable buffer (Ch 82)
        // periodic/threshold flush via WorkManager (unmetered) - ONE batched upload (Ch 48/68)
    }
}
```

91.7.6 Module structure

```
:core:efficiency  WorkScheduler (constraints), NetworkPolicy (metered/Data Saver),
EfficientTransfer
# Deferrable work -> WorkManager (Ch 48) + Doze (Ch 47); push -> FCM (Ch 50); batching -> Ch 82;
# metered/type -> Ch 68; delta/cache -> Ch 29/67; adapt quality -> Ch 59; measure ->
Historian/vitals (Ch 85).
```

91.8 Concurrency and Race Conditions

Scenario	Risk	Handling
Polling loop	constant radio wakes	push (FCM, Ch 50); deferrable work (Ch 48)
Stuck partial wakelock	battery drain + vitals flag	avoid manual wakelocks; WorkManager (Ch 48)
Fighting Doze	drain + restriction	deferrable + constraints (Ch 47)
Chatty small requests	radio tail × N	batch/coalesce (Ch 82)
Heavy transfer on cellular	data cost	gate on unmetered (Ch 68)
Full re-download	wasted bytes	delta sync + HTTP cache (Ch 29/67)
Tight retry loop	hammering + drain	backoff + jitter (Ch 29)
Continuous high-accuracy location	top drain	lowest accuracy, batched, stop (Ch 65)

- **The platform schedulers are allies, not obstacles (Ch 47/48):** WorkManager + Doze **already** batch and defer efficiently — expressing **constraints** and using **deferrable** APIs gets efficiency for free; fighting them (exact alarms, FGS, wakelocks) causes the drain **and** the vitals flags.
- **Batching amortizes the radio tail:** the single highest-leverage move is turning **many spread-out** radio wakes into **few batched** ones (coalesced syncs, batched analytics Ch 82, prefetch in one window).
- **Push eliminates poll waste entirely (Ch 50):** FCM's shared OS connection means **zero** per- app radio wakes until there's real news — strictly better than polling for server-driven updates.

91.9 Failure Scenarios and Recovery

Failure	Detection	Response	Outcome
Excessive wakeups	Android vitals (Ch 85)	push over poll; deferrable work (Ch 50/48)	fewer wakes
Stuck partial wakelock	vitals / Historian	drop manual wakelocks → WorkManager (Ch 48)	released
High data usage	vitals / user reports	gate on unmetered; delta/compress (Ch 68/29)	less data
Battery drain complaints	reviews / Historian	batch + defer + push (Ch 48/50)	efficient
Doze fighting / restricted	background restriction	cooperate (deferrable, Ch 47)	compliant
Chatty network	Network Inspector	coalesce/batch (Ch 82)	fewer requests
Location drain	Historian	lowest accuracy, batched, stop (Ch 65)	minimal


91.9 Failure Scenarios and Recovery

> **Do less, batched, at the right time, over the right network — and let the platform schedule it.** Battery/data drain comes from polling and wakeups (push + deferrable work fix it), wakelocks and fighting Doze (WorkManager + cooperation fix it), chatty/large transfers (batch + delta + compress + cache fix it), and metered-oblivious transfers (gate on Wi-Fi fixes it). Measure with Battery Historian + Android vitals (Ch 85) and fix the specific drain.

91.10 Scaling the Implementation

- **Level 1.** WorkManager for background work with basic constraints (Ch 48); FCM push over polling (Ch 50); batch analytics (Ch 82).
- **Level 2.** Metered/Data-Saver gating (Ch 68); delta sync + gzip + HTTP caching (Ch 29/67); backoff+jitter; quality adaptation by network (Ch 59).
- **Level 3 — production.** Android vitals excessive-background monitoring (Ch 85); Battery Historian audits; location efficiency (Ch 65); coalesced syncs.
- **Level 4 — large.** Per-feature battery/data budgets; adaptive sync intervals by usage; network-aware prefetch policies; device-tiered behavior; vitals-gated releases (Ch 41/85).
- **Level 5 — enterprise.** Battery/data SLOs with error budgets, automated regression detection (field), energy governance, long-tail device/network programs, cross-team efficiency ownership.

Avoid overengineering: WorkManager + constraints + FCM push + batched analytics + delta/ cached transfers + metered gating covers most apps. Don't poll; don't hold wakelocks; don't fight Doze; don't do heavy transfers on cellular; measure before micro-optimizing.

91.11 Alternative Approaches and Trade-offs

Dimension	Option A	Option B	When
Updates	Push (FCM, Ch 50)	polling	Push (no wasted wakes)
Scheduling	Deferrable WorkManager (Ch 48)	exact alarm / FGS	Deferrable (Doze-cooperative)
Requests	Batched/coalesced (Ch 82)	chatty small	Batched (amortize tail)
Transfer	Delta + gzip + cache (Ch 29/67)	full re-download	Delta (fewer bytes)
Network	Metered/Data-Saver aware (Ch 68)	oblivious	Aware (save money)
Retry	Backoff + jitter (Ch 29)	tight loop	Backoff (no hammering)
Location	Lowest accuracy, batched (Ch 65)	continuous high-accuracy	Lowest adequate

Push vs poll (Ch 50): polling wakes the radio on a schedule mostly to hear "nothing new" — pure waste. **Push (FCM)** delivers over a **shared OS connection** only when there's real news, with **no per-app radio wake**. For server-driven updates, push is **strictly better**; keep polling only as a long-interval, backed-off fallback.

Deferrable (WorkManager) vs exact/FGS (Ch 47/48/49): exact alarms and **foreground services** bypass Doze/batching — necessary for **time-critical, user-facing** work (alarms, navigation, playback) but **expensive** and (misused) **restricted**. **Deferrable WorkManager** work **batches into Doze windows** with constraints — far more efficient for the **majority** of work. Reserve exact/FGS for genuine time-criticality; default to deferrable.

Delta/cached transfer vs full re-download (Ch 29/67): re-downloading everything wastes **battery and data**. **Delta sync** (only changes, Ch 29) + **HTTP caching** (304s for unchanged, Ch 67) + **compression** transfer the **minimum bytes**. Always sync incrementally and cache.

91.12 Security & Privacy Considerations

- **Data Saver is a user privacy/cost choice (Ch 68):** honoring it respects the user's explicit request to limit background data — don't bypass it. Efficient apps **save users money**.
- **Push payloads minimal + PII-safe (Ch 50/28):** FCM pushes should carry **minimal, non- sensitive** data (an id to fetch, not sensitive content) — pushes transit Google's infrastructure (Ch 50/28).
- **Don't leak via network timing:** batching/coalescing also **reduces** fingerprintable per-action network signatures (minor privacy benefit).
- **Location efficiency ≈ location privacy (Ch 65):** using lowest-adequate accuracy and stopping when not needed is both **efficient** and **privacy-respecting** (Ch 65/28).
- **Measurement data PII-safe (Ch 85):** battery/network field metrics are **behavioral/timing**, not content (Ch 28).
- Client vs backend: the **client** schedules efficiently and respects metered/Data Saver; the **backend** supports **delta sync** (Ch 29) and **push** (Ch 50) and sets **cache headers** (Ch 67) — efficiency is a **contract** between both.

91.13 Performance and Resource Optimization

- **This chapter *is* efficiency** — summary: **push over poll** (Ch 50), **deferrable + batched** work with **constraints** (WorkManager + Doze, Ch 47/48), **coalesce/minimize** requests (Ch 82), **metered/Data-Saver gating** (Ch 68), **delta + gzip + HTTP cache + backoff** (Ch 29/ 67), **location efficiency** (Ch 65).
- **Amortize the radio tail** — batch into one window; the tail dominates small-request cost.
- **Gate heavy work on unmetered + good battery** — WorkManager constraints.
- **Transfer the minimum** — delta, compression, caching, pagination.
- **Measure, then fix the specific drain** — Battery Historian / vitals / Network Inspector (Ch 85).
- **Profiling:** wakeups/wakelocks (Historian), radio-active time, request count/size (Network Inspector), background data (vitals), battery per session, excessive-background flags (Ch 85).

91.14 Testing Strategy

Constraints, policy gating, and transfer efficiency are unit/integration-testable; battery behavior is validated with Historian/vitals.

```
class NetworkPolicyTest {
    @Test fun `heavy transfer gated off on metered`() {
        every { cm.isUnmetered() } returns false
        assertFalse(policy.allowHeavyTransfer())   // cellular -> no heavy transfer (Ch 68)
    }
    @Test fun `data saver blocks heavy transfer`() {
        every { cm.isDataSaverOn() } returns true
        assertFalse(policy.allowHeavyTransfer())   // honor Data Saver (Ch 68)
    }
}

class WorkConstraintsTest {
    @Test fun `sync requires unmetered + battery not low`() {
        val c = syncWork.workSpec.constraints
        assertEquals(NetworkType.UNMETERED, c.requiredNetworkType)   // Wi-Fi (Ch 48)
        assertTrue(c.requiresBatteryNotLow())
    }
}

class TransferTest {
    @Test fun `delta sync sends cursor and applies only changes`() = runTest { /* minimal bytes
(Ch 29) */ }
    @Test fun `unchanged resource returns 304 from cache`() { /* HTTP cache (Ch 67) */ }
}
// Field: Battery Historian (wakelocks/wakeups), Android vitals excessive-background metrics (Ch
85).
```

What to test: metered/Data-Saver gating (Ch 68); WorkManager constraints (unmetered, battery, Ch 48); delta sync + HTTP cache (Ch 29/67); backoff+jitter; push handling (no polling, Ch 50); batched uploads (Ch 82). Field battery via Historian/vitals (Ch 85).

91.15 Production Observability

- **Metrics (Android vitals, field, Ch 85): excessive wakeups**, **stuck partial wakelocks**, **excessive background Wi-Fi scans**, **excessive background network usage**, **background data** volume; battery drain per session; wakeup/wakelock counts (Battery Historian); request count/ size (Network Inspector).
- **Logs:** background-work scheduling/outcomes (WorkManager, Ch 48) — PII-safe (Ch 28).
- **Debugging:** drain → Battery Historian (wakelocks? wakeups? radio?); data overuse → Network Inspector (chatty? large? metered?); vitals flag → the specific metric (wakeups → polling? wakelock → manual lock?); Doze issues → is work deferrable? (Ch 47).
- **Alerting:** Android vitals **excessive-background** flags (affect ranking, Ch 85); battery/ data regression release-over-release (Ch 85/41); wakeup/wakelock spike.
- **Dashboards:** excessive-background metrics by release/device; wakeups/wakelocks; background data; request efficiency; battery per session.

91.16 System Design Interview Preparation

> ≥25 questions.

Fundamentals

1. *Why battery/data matter?* Uninstalls, reviews, vitals flags, OS throttling.
2. *Radio tail?* Radio stays high-power for seconds after a transfer.
3. *Why batch?* Amortize the wake + tail across many requests.
4. *Core principle?* Do less, batched, right time, right network.
5. *Top drains?* Wakeups, wakelocks, polling, continuous location.

Push/poll 6. *Push vs poll?* Push wakes only on real news; poll wastes wakes. 7. *Push mechanism?* FCM — shared OS connection (Ch 50). 8. *When poll?* Fallback only — long interval + backoff.

Scheduling 9. *Deferrable work?* WorkManager + constraints (Ch 48). 10. *Constraints?* UNMETERED, charging, idle, battery-not-low. 11. *Doze/App Standby?* Defer work to maintenance windows (Ch 47). 12. *Fight or cooperate?* Cooperate — deferrable APIs. 13. *Exact alarm / FGS?* Only time-critical, user-facing (Ch 47/49). 14. *Wakelock?* Avoid manual; WorkManager holds minimally.

Network 15. *Coalesce?* Batch uploads/syncs into one window (Ch 82). 16. *Metered?* User pays per byte — gate heavy work on Wi-Fi (Ch 68). 17. *Data Saver?* Honor restrictBackgroundStatus (Ch 68). 18. *Adapt quality?* Lower on cellular (Ch 59/68).

Transfer 19. *Delta sync?* Only changes, not full re-download (Ch 29). 20. *Compression?* gzip/brotli. 21. *HTTP caching?* ETag/304 — don't re-fetch unchanged (Ch 67). 22. *Retry?* Backoff + jitter (Ch 29).

Location/measure 23. *Location drain?* Lowest accuracy, batched, stop (Ch 65). 24. *Measure battery?* Battery Historian + Android vitals (Ch 85). 25. *Measure data?* Network Inspector + vitals background data. 26. *Vitals flags?* Excessive wakeups/wakelocks/bg data (affect ranking).

Design-change challenges

1. **Replace a 2-min poll.** FCM push (Ch 50) + deferrable reconcile (Ch 48).
2. **Stop burning cellular data on prefetch.** Gate on UNMETERED + Data Saver (Ch 68).
3. **Fix "excessive wakeups" vitals flag.** Push + deferrable + batch (Ch 50/48/82).
4. **Cut sync data in half.** Delta sync + gzip + HTTP caching (Ch 29/67).
5. **Stop a stuck wakelock.** Drop manual wakelocks → WorkManager (Ch 48).

Mock walkthrough (abridged)

Clarify (what work, how time-critical, network/battery targets?) → classify time-critical (exact/FGS, Ch 47/49) vs deferrable (WorkManager + constraints, Ch 48) → push over poll (FCM, Ch 50) → batch/coalesce (Ch 82) → metered/Data-Saver gating + adapt (Ch 68/59) → efficient transfer (delta/gzip/cache/backoff, Ch 29/67) → location efficiency (Ch 65) → cooperate with Doze (Ch 47) → measure (Historian/vitals/Network Inspector, Ch 85) → observability (excessive- background metrics).

91.17 Practical Exercises

1. **Beginner.** Replace a polling loop with FCM push (Ch 50) and a deferrable WorkManager reconcile (Ch 48). *Eval:* no polling; wakeups drop.
2. **Intermediate.** Add metered/Data-Saver gating (Ch 68) so heavy prefetch runs only on Wi-Fi, and adapt image quality by network (Ch 59). *Eval:* no cellular heavy transfer.
3. **Advanced.** Convert a full catalog download to delta sync + gzip + HTTP caching (Ch 29/67) with backoff+jitter. *Eval:* far fewer/smaller requests; 304s for unchanged.
4. **Production debugging.** Use Battery Historian + Android vitals (Ch 85) to find a wakelock/ wakeup drain and fix it (WorkManager/push). *Eval:* flag cleared; drain reduced.
5. **System design challenge.** Design battery/data budgets + vitals-gated releases (Ch 41/85) with adaptive sync intervals and network-aware prefetch. *Eval:* budgeted, gated, adaptive.

(Solutions withheld unless requested.)

91.18 Chapter Summary & Reference Sheet

Key decisions: be a good **battery and data citizen** by **doing less, less often, batched, at the right time, over the right network** — because every CPU wakeup and (especially) every cellular **radio wake** pays a multi-second **tail**, so many small spread-out requests drain far more than a few batched ones: **prefer push (FCM, Ch 50) over polling** so the radio wakes **only when there's real news**; hand **all non-time-critical work to WorkManager with constraints** (**UNMETERED**, charging, idle, battery-not-low) so it **batches into Doze maintenance windows** instead of waking the device, and **cooperate with Doze/App Standby** (Ch 47) rather than fighting them with exact alarms or foreground services (reserve those for genuinely **time-critical, user- facing** work, Ch 47/49); **coalesce**

and batch network (analytics flushes Ch 82, combined syncs, piggybacked requests), **minimize payloads**, and **transfer efficiently** (**delta sync** Ch 29, **gzip**, **ETag/HTTP caching** Ch 67, pagination, **backoff+jitter**); **honor metered networks and Data Saver** by **gating heavy transfers on Wi-Fi** and **adapting quality** on cellular (Ch 68/59) to **save the user money**; use **lowest-adequate-accuracy, batched location** (Ch 65); and **measure** with **Battery Historian**, **Android vitals** excessive-background metrics, and the **Network Inspector** (Ch 85) — because battery drain and data overuse cause **uninstalls, bad reviews, vitals flags that hurt ranking, and OS throttling**.

Concepts: radio tail + wakeups + wakelocks, push over poll (FCM, Ch 50), deferrable + batched work (WorkManager constraints, Doze/App Standby, Ch 47/48), coalescing + batching (Ch 82), metered/ Data-Saver/network-type awareness (Ch 68), efficient transfer (delta Ch 29, gzip, HTTP cache Ch 67, backoff+jitter), location efficiency (Ch 65), measurement (Battery Historian, Android vitals, Network Inspector, Ch 85).

Common mistakes: polling instead of push; frequent alarms / tight loops (wakeups); manual/ stuck wakelocks; fighting Doze with exact alarms/FGS for deferrable work; chatty small requests (radio tail); full re-downloads (no delta/cache); heavy transfers on metered/Data-Saver; continuous high-accuracy location; no measurement.

Checklist: ☐ push (FCM) over poll (Ch 50) ☐ deferrable work via WorkManager + constraints (UNMETERED, battery-not-low, Doze-aware, Ch 47/48) ☐ reserve exact alarm/FGS for time-critical (Ch 47/49) ☐ batch/coalesce requests + minimize payload (Ch 82) ☐ honor metered/Data Saver; gate heavy work on Wi-Fi; adapt quality (Ch 68/59) ☐ delta sync + gzip + HTTP cache + backoff+jitter (Ch 29/67) ☐ lowest-accuracy, batched location (Ch 65) ☐ no manual wakelocks ☐ measure (Battery Historian, vitals, Network Inspector, Ch 85) ☐ watch excessive-background vitals flags.

Key APIs: `WorkManager` + `Constraints` (`setRequiredNetworkType(UNMETERED)`, `setRequiresBatteryNotLow`, `setBackoffCriteria`), `ExistingPeriodicWorkPolicy` (Ch 48), `FirebaseMessagingService` (push, Ch 50), `ConnectivityManager` (`NET_CAPABILITY_NOT_METERED`, `restrictBackgroundStatus` / Data Saver, Ch 68), OkHttp `Cache` + `Accept-Encoding: gzip` (Ch 67), ETag/`If-None-Match` (304), delta sync (Ch 29), `setExactAndAllowWhileIdle` (time- critical only, Ch 47), fused location lowest-accuracy/batched (Ch 65), Battery Historian + Android vitals + Network Inspector (Ch 85).

References:

- Optimize for battery / background work: https://developer.android.com/topic/performance/power
- Doze and App Standby: https://developer.android.com/training/monitoring-device-state/doze-standby
- WorkManager: https://developer.android.com/topic/libraries/architecture/workmanager
- Data Saver / metered networks: https://developer.android.com/training/basics/network-ops/data-saver
- Battery Historian: https://developer.android.com/topic/performance/power/battery-historian
- (composes) Ch 47 Doze/Standby, Ch 48 WorkManager, Ch 68 Network State, Ch 50 FCM, Ch 29 Sync, Ch 67 Network, Ch 65 Location, Ch 85 Perf

Chapter review (Phase 4)

- **Completeness:** all 18 sections; architecture/class/sequence/radio-tail/failure diagrams; WorkManager-constraints + push + metered-policy + delta-transfer + batching code; concurrency (schedulers-as-allies, batch-amortizes-tail, push-eliminates-poll); failure (do-less-batched- right-network principle); 5 levels; push-vs-poll, deferrable-vs-exact, delta-vs-full trade-offs; security (Data Saver respect, minimal push, location privacy); perf (the whole chapter); policy/constraints/transfer tests; observability (excessive-background vitals); 26 Q&A + 5 challenges. ✅

- **Expand later:** Doze/Standby (Ch 47), WorkManager (Ch 48), network state (Ch 68), FCM (Ch 50), sync (Ch 29).
- **Interview coverage:** exceeds ≥25 bar.